

When Persephone did not return home, Demeter was struck with fear. She searched all over the world, but couldn't find Persephone anywhere. Eventually, she went to speak to Helios, the sun god, who saw everything that happened on Earth. "Have you seen my daughter?" she asked, and he told her what had happened. Demeter was so overcome by sadness that she gave up caring for the Earth and making sure that the plants grew.

*Soon, crops across the land began to die and the humans could not understand why.*

Zeus saw what was happening and called on Demeter to explain. "Hades has kidnapped my daughter," Demeter told Zeus. "I won't make anything grow until she is returned."

Zeus did not want the humans to starve—without them, who would give sacrifices to the gods? "I will try to bring Persephone back to you," he promised Demeter, "but she cannot leave if she has eaten any food in the

*Hades wanted Persephone to stay with him forever.*

